

For this assignment, you will write up as much material as possible in class. At the end of class, you can take a picture of it with your phone before I collect it, scan it, and email it to you that evening. You can work on (rearrange, refine) this in-class material on your own as homework, but you should try to stay as close as you can to the in-class material you wrote. Do not use LLMs or any other so-called “artificial intelligence”: this is a writing class, after all! Sometime before the deadline, turn in a PDF or DOC file *both* (1) via Canvas, *and also* (2) to my email address (scm244@cornell.edu).

Deadline: Tuesday October 13th 10pm

Writing Assignment #2

Choose one of the following texts to write on:

- David Gauthier, “Morality and Advantage”
- Joseph Butler, “Sermon 11: Upon the Love of Our Neighbour”
- Joel Feinberg, “Psychological Egoism”

From this text, find a point you want to write about, and carry out the following tasks in a sequence of sections:

- Classify this point as (a) an argument in support of some position, (b) an argument against some position, or (c) a criticism of an argument for or against a position.
- If (a) or (b):
 - explain the *position* being argued for or against (i.e., the position that’s at stake)
 - reconstruct the *argument* in numbered premise-conclusion form
 - think up and explain a potential *criticism* of that argument (make sure it’s a criticism not already well explained in the text)
 - state precisely (but not necessarily at great length) how the criticism works: does it challenge a premise of the argument? does it challenge the support relation holding between the premises and the conclusion? does it identify some other kind of flaw in the argument?
 - think up and explain what you consider to be the strongest *defense* of the argument against this criticism
- If (c):
 - explain the *position* the argument is for or against (i.e., the position that’s at stake)
 - reconstruct the *argument* in numbered premise-conclusion form
 - explain the *criticism* of that argument
 - state precisely (but not necessarily at great length) how the criticism works: does it challenge a premise of the argument? does it challenge the support relation holding between the premises and the conclusion? does it identify some other kind of flaw in the argument?
 - think up and explain what you consider to be the strongest *defense* of the argument against this criticism
 - think up and explain what you consider to be the strongest *rejoinder* on behalf of the criticism

Your submission should have at least 1000 words total